

Annotation Guidelines

Project: Customer Support Ticket Intent Classification

1. Project Objective

The objective of this project was to classify customer support messages into predefined intent categories. The annotated dataset is intended to simulate a real-world AI data annotation workflow used for training customer support chatbots, ticket routing systems, and Natural Language Processing (NLP) models.

2. Dataset Description

- Dataset Size: 100 customer support messages
- Task Type: Text Classification (Intent Classification)
- Language: English
- Annotation Type: Single-label classification

Each customer message was assigned one primary intent label representing the customer's main reason for contacting support.

3. Intent Labels

☐ Billing

Use this label when the customer's primary concern relates to:

- Charges
- Payments
- Refunds
- Invoices
- Subscription fees
- Billing errors

Example

"I was billed twice for my subscription."

☐ **Account**

Use this label when the customer is requesting assistance with:

- Login issues
- Password reset
- Account security
- Email changes
- Account verification
- Account recovery

Example

"I forgot my password."

☐ **Shipping**

Use this label when the issue involves:

- Delivery status
- Tracking
- Missing packages
- Damaged products
- Wrong deliveries
- Shipping delays

Example

"My package says delivered, but I haven't received it."

□ **Technical Issue**

Use this label when the customer reports:

- Application crashes
- Website errors
- Loading problems
- Buttons not working
- Software bugs
- System failures

Example

"The app crashes every time I open it."

□ **General Inquiry**

Use this label for informational requests that are not reporting a problem.

Examples include:

- Product information
- Pricing
- Business hours
- Available plans
- Policies
- Feature availability

Example

"Do you offer student discounts?"

4. Annotation Rules

The following rules were applied throughout the annotation process:

- Assign only one label per customer message.

- Select the label that best represents the customer's primary intent.
 - Ignore secondary issues unless they are the main reason for the support request.
 - Maintain consistent labeling throughout the dataset.
 - Review ambiguous cases before finalizing labels.
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5. Handling Ambiguous Cases

Some customer messages contained more than one issue.

In these situations:

- The customer's primary objective was identified first.
 - Labels were assigned based on the issue requiring immediate resolution.
 - Difficult examples were documented in the Annotator Notes column for later review.
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6. Quality Assurance Process

A manual quality review was conducted after annotation.

The review process included:

- Checking label consistency.
 - Identifying ambiguous classifications.
 - Reviewing difficult examples.
 - Correcting inconsistent labels.
 - Documenting QA decisions in the Reviewer Notes column.
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7. Annotation Principles

During annotation, the following principles were followed:

- Consistency over personal interpretation.
 - Prioritize customer intent rather than keywords alone.
 - Consider the full context of each message.
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- Apply the annotation guidelines uniformly across all samples.
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8. Completion Summary

- Dataset annotated: 100 customer messages
- Intent categories: 5
- Annotation method: Manual
- Quality assurance: Manual review completed
- Reviewer feedback incorporated into final dataset